Backbone Detectives · TA Brief

Learning goal: I can use inside body clues to sort tricky animals and explain my choice.

Watch (staff preview first)

Short silent teacher demonstration clip for this lesson's model and practical sequence · preview before class use.

Adult Support Routine

No cold calling; nobody is asked to read difficult text aloud.

Give time to start -> point to the relevant place -> rephrase -> offer a small prompt or word bank -> reduce to a limited choice.

Beside the You do in the pupil book, mark I (independent), S (supported) or C (choice).

Must-Know Words

vertebrate: an animal with a backbone inside

invertebrate: an animal with no backbone inside

evidence: a body clue that proves your choice

exoskeleton: a hard case on the outside of a body

Key Answers

A. Snakes and fish have no legs, yet they have a backbone inside.

A. A snake is a vertebrate because it has a backbone inside.

Made by Matt

1. An internal backbone (spine). 2. Snake = vertebrate (spine inside); crab = invertebrate (hard shell outside, no spine). 3. Legs, wings, or size do not show whether there is a spine inside.